Millen Woods School Council
September 17, 2025 Meeting Minutes

Welcome & Introductions: Ashley

- Meeting called to order at 6:35
- Motion to approve agenda – Rachel
- Motion to approve June 2025 minutes – Jake
- Introductions were made - Refer to the attached Attendance Document
- Overview of council and mission statement – Council's purpose is to fundraise for enrichment opportunities at the school, which the Board does not cover

Admin Report: Serena

- We have had an increase in enrolment with a lot of new families, both from Carriage Crossing and families who have moved into the Eastbridge neighbourhood
- Meet the Community night was a great evening, and running it concurrently with the book fair continues to go well. Families enjoyed checking out the new playground
- The transition in administration has gone very well, with a lot of continuity and communication between Serena and Karen
- We have our first bus in 9 years! So far, it is going successfully. Older students have been trained in leadership capacity as bus safety patrollers
- Kindie playground is a hit, and the installation went well. We are still waiting for the shade tarp to be installed.
- Older students who are interested in helping out with younger classes have been providing support during lunch
- School Day issues should be resolved now
- Apple donations are appreciated
- Extra-curricular clubs are kicking off, and staff are working on revamping past clubs to make them engaging for students. Intramural soccer is starting up soon.
- Terry Fox fundraiser and walk is coming up
- Student enrollment is 309 for 2025-2026

2025/2026 Budget: Ashley

- The budget for this school year was approved by last year's council. Ashley presented the approved budget and explained the significant fundraisers and the areas that the council is responsible for funding.
- Refer to the attached budget for details.
- Council discussed ways to bring more visibility to the major fundraisers so that parents who aren't on council know what the funds are for and can understand the types of enrichment activities that are required to be funded by council. In general, we have more success with our fundraisers when we communicate that we are fundraising for a specific thing (i.e. playground)
- Council discussed the student subsidy funding and what it is intended for. There was a discussion on how we can get more visibility that this funding exists for students who need it. Serena will take this away to consider how it should be communicated.
- There are council members who have connections that may be willing to volunteer with garden maintenance to save funding. Rachel suggested reaching out to the seniors' home. Emily B has family members who may be willing to assist

Action item: Serena will book the gym as a backup for Lollypalooza (year-end social) in case we need to cancel for weather again. The date is June 18, 2026.
Action item: Serena to consider communication around student subsidies

2025/2026 Council Positions: Ashley

- Co-chairs: Ashley & Dan & Emily B
- Treasurer: Erin
- Secretary: Emily L & Hannah
- Communications Officer: Emily B
- IT Officer: Jake (HDMI Cable Bringer & Movie Night Man)
- Volunteer Coordinator: Colleen
- Voting Parents: As per the attendance listing attached
- Attendance was taken by Ashley
- Formation of the 2025/2026 Council: Ashley moved to approve the officers and voting members for the 2025-2026 Millen Woods School Council as noted in the attached attendance listing. Motion was passed unanimously.

Action item: Colleen to get a School Day communication out asap for pizza volunteers
Action item: Jake to bring an HDMI cable for the next meeting 😊

Meet The Community/Book Fair Feedback: All

- Book selection was amazing, and multiple books sold out this year.
- Book sales were $1k higher this year compared to last year.
- We earned $2.4k in Scholastic credits; however, we are limited on what we can buy with these funds. There is the option to take a lower amount in cash for our fundraising credits. Council discussed what to do with the fundraising credit and decided to take the Scholastic credits for this year. We can purchase items for student prizes and potentially prizes and rewards to be used for our fall fundraiser.
- Council discussed bringing back the book swap we ran 2 years ago. There is support for having it every other year. To consider whether we can do this with the fall fundraiser.

Action item: Add book swap discussion to the next agenda – see also discussion below regarding fall fundraiser

Snack and Lunch Program: Ashley

- ESNS will start next week. We will do pizza on Tuesdays, rotation between 4 options for Thursdays, and Menchies on the first Friday of each month.
- Apple donations are appreciated
- Popcorn Fridays will start in a few weeks on the Fridays when we don't have Menchies

2025-2026 Fundraising Calendar: Ashley

- The calendar was approved at last year's council and will be attached to the minutes for reference.

Fall Fundraiser Brainstorming: All

- We ran a survey last year regarding parents' feedback on fundraisers. The survey indicated that most families would rather make donations towards events (i.e. dance-a-thon, read-a-thon) instead of product sales.
- Brainstormed ideas for the fall fundraiser, which included:
    - Fall festival – fundraising through the sale of apple cider, candy apples, face painting, etc., can coordinate a farm donation for families to drop off pumpkins, and a community building event. Logistically, it could be difficult with the early November timing to run an outdoor event, and there may be no availability to book the gym.
    - Read-a-thon – this was well received when we ran it last time, but we would plan to do a shorter time frame (last time was a month – would be ideal to do a week or two). Can bring in new ideas such as dress as your favourite character day, sale of small products as part of it (stickers, bookmarks, buttons), can we bring back the book swap as part of it?

    - Coffee mornings – sell coffee at school drop off and allow parents to connect and chat with the community
    - Farm produce box – we have done this in the past and it was successful, but it was very difficult to find enough volunteers as it is very labour-intensive (sorting & handing out the boxes)
- A subcommittee was formed to discuss the ideas and come up with a fundraiser.

Action item: Subcommittee to connect: Emily B, Colleen, Sandeep, Sam

Winter Clothing Drive: Steph

- The winter clothing drive collects gently used coats, snow pants, boots and running shoes and distributes them to school(s) in need in Waterloo Region
- This year, Sandowne will be receiving our donations, and Karen will come to pick them up (Karen Grant O'Grady was MW's principal last year and has now moved to Sandowne)

Action item: Steph will connect with Ann about the signage and collection box. Steph will send Ann a School Day post to go out about the donations

Adjournment: Ashley

- Meeting adjourned at 8:26

Next meeting: October 8, 2025, at 6:30 in person with a virtual link

MILLEN WOODS SCHOOL COUNCIL
ATTENDANCE SHEET FOR September 17, 2025

#	Name	**Position**	**Email**	**Initial for Attendance**
1.	Serena Maharaj	Principal	serena_maharaj@wrdsb.ca	SM
2.	Ashley Feeney	Co-Chair	ashleylfeeney@gmail.com	AF
3.	Dan Collens	Co-Chair	dan.collens@gmail.com	Regrets
4.	Emily Bell	Co-Chair / Communications Officer	ercorner@gmail.com	EB
5.	Emily Lutz	Co-Secretary	emilywyss@gmail.com	EL
6.	Hannah Weir	Co-Secretary	hannah.weir11@gmail.com	HW
7.	Erin Evans	Treasurer	erinnfranklin@gmail.com	EE
8.	Colleen Araya	Volunteer Coordinator	colleenmw@hotmail.com	CA
9.	Jake Billo	IT Officer	jake@billo.ca	JB
10.	Steph Honour	Voting Member	stephaniemhonour@gmail.com	SH
11.	Kristen Smith	Voting Member	kj_martin@hotmail.com	Regrets
12.	Sarah Nickel	Voting Member	nickelsarahm@gmail.com	Regrets
13.	Rachel Sarchielli	Voting Member	sarchrachel@gmail.com	RS
14.	Daniella Cross-Henderson	Voting Member	daniellacross@gmail.com	Regrets
15.	Sandeep Shroff	Voting Member	sandeep.k.shroff@gmail.com	SS
16.	Sam Powell	Voting Member	samantha_powell_4@hotmail.com	SP
17.	Sandra Ribes	Voting Member	mrs.s.ribes@gmail.com	SR
18.	Meaghan McGloin	Voting Member	meaghan.mcgloin@gmail.com	Regrets
19.	Pradeep Chandran	Voting Member	pradeep24s@gmail.com	Regrets
20.	Julia Klein		julia.kleinhb@gmail.com	
21.	Maryam Elsabagh		maryam_rashad@hotmail.com	
22.	Nicolas Mellet		nicolas.mellet@net.com	
23.	Sarah Boss		Slouboss@gmail.com	
24.	Hamed Hashemi		s.h.hashemi65@gmail.com	
25.	Michael Da Silva		michaeljdasilva@gmail.com	
26.	Raj Pancha		Rajathepan@hotmail.com	
27.				
28.				
29.				
30.				

Millen Woods Public School
School Council
Monthly Report 2024/25

	September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	September	YTD totals	Budget 2023/2024	
Opening Balance School Council Account	26,974.56	28,730.62	29,768.63	30,030.09	30,030.09	30,456.35	30,768.59	32,070.01	33,227.71	36,256.81	38,795.75	36,621.43	36,621.43		
Opening Balance WEFI Account	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	30,297.41	30,297.41	30,322.41	30,322.41	30,322.41	30,322.41		
Fundraising Activities (Revenue)															
WEFI Donations													0.00	0.00	
ESNS (Lunches - Tuesday, Thursday, 1 Friday a month)	2,673.65					1600.50	1332.95		1350.05	2549.05			9,506.20	5,500.00	
Mabel's Labels (ongoing)	128.40									51.91			180.31	100.00	
TruEarth (ongoing)													0.00	0.00	
Factory Shoes (ongoing)													0.00	300.00	$620 sitting in Factory Shoe Account
Meet the Community (Sept)			170.00										170.00	200.00	Food Trucks
Fall Fundraiser (Oct) - Esta Chocolates		468.00	354.49										822.49	1,000.00	
Winter Wonderland (January)					306.00								306.00	200.00	Pizza Sales
Winter Fundraiser (March) - Dance-a-thon							5641.27		25.00				5,666.27	5,000.00	
Movie Night (May 1) - Pizza and Popcorn									70.01				70.01	0.00	
Year-End Social (June 11)										-56.71			-56.71	0.00	
Popcorn Sales	694.00	978.00	275.00		1438.00			942.04	1116.00	132.00			5,575.04	6,400.00	
Spring Fundraiser - Ice Cream Sandwich Sales (April, May, June)								362.00	449.76	2.35			814.11	500.00	
HST Rebates								-86.34					-86.34	0.00	
Dominos Family Pizza Night									120.00				120.00	0.00	
Fundraising Activities total (School Account)	**3,496.05**	**1,446.00**	**799.49**	**0.00**	**1,744.00**	**1,600.50**	**2,437.45**	**1,217.70**	**3,105.82**	**2,678.60**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**18,525.61**		
Fundraising Activities total (WEFI)	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**4,536.77**	**0.00**	**25.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**4,561.77**		
Fundraising Total (both accounts)	**$3,496.05**	**$1,446.00**	**$799.49**	**$0.00**	**$1,744.00**	**$1,600.50**	**$6,974.22**	**$1,217.70**	**$3,130.82**	**$2,678.60**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$23,087.38**	**19,200.00**	
Expenses															
General Administration			130.04		56.87	$59.48	63.35		76.72	139.66	4.06		530.18	500.00	
Home & Classroom reading													0.00	1,500.00	
Grade 6 Graduation													0.00	200.00	
Playground bins (13 classes x $75)	$720.93												720.93	500.00	refill in spring 2025
Musical Instruments Reserve						260.00							260.00	200.00	piano tuning
Extracurricular Clubs													0.00	0.00	
Playground Maintenance													0.00	0.00	
Donation to another School								60.00					60.00	0.00	
Enrichment - School Trips/Transportation	$509.53					203.81					509.53		1,222.87	2,500.00	allocated $200/class
Enrichment - School Events or Resources											1660.73		1,660.73	5,000.00	
Dance-a-thon							1072.68						1,072.68	1,000.00	DJ and photobooth
Area Track Meet Bussing	$509.53												509.53	500.00	
Popcorn Purchase		407.99	407.99		374.40	$764.97							1,955.35	2,500.00	
Student Subsides													0.00	100.00	
Athletics Requests													0.00	500.00	carry year over year
Grounds Maintenance (plants, mulch, garden supplies)													0.00	750.00	
Winter Wonderland					886.47								886.47	1,200.00	
Playground Improvement													0.00	1,500.00	carry year over year ... Gaga Ball Pit $3000
													0.00	0.00	
													0.00	0.00	
Expenses total	**1,739.99**	**407.99**	**538.03**	**0.00**	**1,317.74**	**1,288.26**	**1,136.03**	**60.00**	**76.72**	**139.66**	**2,174.32**	**0.00**	**8,878.74**	**18,450.00**	
Ending Balance School Council Account	**28,730.62**	**29,768.63**	**30,030.09**	**30,030.09**	**30,456.35**	**30,768.59**	**32,070.01**	**33,227.71**	**36,256.81**	**38,795.75**	**36,621.43**	**36,621.43**	**36,621.43**		
Ending Balance WEFI Account	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**30,297.41**	**30,297.41**	**30,322.41**	**30,322.41**	**30,322.41**	**30,322.41**	**30,322.41**		
Total Balance	**$54,491.26**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,790.73**	**$55,790.73**	**$56,216.99**	**$56,529.23**	**$62,367.42**	**$63,525.12**	**$66,579.22**	**$69,118.16**	**$66,943.84**	**$66,943.84**	**$66,943.84**	**750.00**	

2025/2026 Budget

A.	**School Council Starting Balance**		**32,070.01**			
	WEFI Starting Balance		**30,297.41**			
	Further revenues:	April - June				
		Kindie Playground				
	Further expenses:	April - June Expenses	**50,000.00**			
	Estimated Fundraising total		**12,367.42**	should be at least $2,000 for gagaball pit & athletic request carry forward		
	Fundraising activities (estimate)					
	ESNS Lunches	ongoing	5,500.00			
	Friday Popcorn Sales	ongoing	6,400.00	based on 100 cases (32bags/case) at $2/bag		
	Mabel's Labels	ongoing	100.00			
	Factory Shoe	ongoing	300.00			
	Meet the Community	Sept. 10	200.00	Food Trucks		
	Fall Fundraiser	October	1,000.00			
	Winter Wonderland	Jan. 15	200.00	Pizza Sales (Pre-Order and Slices available night of the event)		
	Dance-a-thon & Photo Booth	Mar. 6	5,000.00			
	Movie Night	Nov. 19	400.00	Popcorn & Pizza Sales (Pre-Order & slices night of the event)		
	Ice Cream Sandwiches	Apr. 13, May 11, June 15	1,000.00			
	Year-End Social	May 5	0.00			
B.	**Estimated Fundraising total**		**20,100.00**			
	Expenses (estimate)					
	General Administration		500.00			
	Decodable Texts		1,000.00			
	Grade 6 Celebration		200.00			
	Playground bins		750.00	refill in spring 2026		
	Kindie Playground Upgrades (bikes, equipment, etc.)		2,500.00			
	Musical Instruments or Piano Tuning		275.00			
	Extracurricular Clubs		0.00			
	Playground maintenance		0.00			
	Donation to another school		0.00			
	Enrichment - School Trips/Transportation		2,500.00	allocated ~$200/class (12 classes)		
	Enrichment - School events, technology replace, resources		2,500.00			
	Dance-a-thon		1,200.00	DJ and Photo Booth rental		
	Area Track Meet Bussing		500.00			
	Friday Popcorn Purchase		2,500.00	(100 cases at 32bags /case) at $24/case		
	Student subsidies		100.00			
	Athletics requests		500.00	carry forward budget year over year	$1,000.00	carry over since 2024/2025 school year
	Grounds Maintenance (mud hill mulch & garden clean up)		750.00	carry forward budget year over year	$750.00	carry over from 2024/2025 school year
	Winter Wonderland		1,200.00			
	Student Prizes		300.00			
	Teacher Appreciation		200.00			
	Playground Improvement		1,500.00	GagaBall Pit $3000 .... 2025/2026 install	$1,500.00	carry over from 2024/2025 school year
C.	**Estimated Expenses Total**		**18,975.00**			
A+B-C	**School Council Projected Surplus**		**1,125.00**	surplus should be at least amount in carry forward		

Draft budget presented to Karen on March 24, 2025
Draft budget presented to Council on April 9, 2025
Budget approved unanimously on June 11, 2025

Fundraising Calendar for the 2025 - 2026 School Year

To help our families plan for the school year, see the calendar below, which illustrates when fundraising campaigns are anticipated to begin. As always, families are not obligated to participate in these campaigns; however, your family's participation is much appreciated and helps support many enrichment activities that form part of the school year!

MONTH	FUNDRAISER (FUNDS RETURNING TO SCHOOL)	CHARITABLE DONATION (MONEY TO OUTSIDE CHARITY)
September	Meet the Community Night (Food Trucks) & Book Fair - Wed. Sept 10	Terry Fox Run (donation completed online)
October	Fall Fundraiser	Cold Weather Clothing Drive - Oct 1 - 15
November	Family Movie Night (popcorn & pizza for purchase) - Wed. Nov. 19	
December		Week of Giving: Nov. 24 - Nov. 28
January	Winter Wonderland (free event for families) – Thurs. Jan. 15	
February		
March	Dance-a-thon Fundraiser – Fri. Mar. 6	
April		
May	PROGrant Family Night (free event for families) - Tues. May 5	
June	Year-End Social – Thurs. June 18	
Ongoing	1) Mabel's Labels - https://mabelslabels.ca/en_CA/ Select "Support a Fundraiser" and type "Millen Woods Public School (Waterloo)" 2) Factory Shoe - mention Millen Woods at checkout in-store or use code: 0350025 online at checkout https://www.factoryshoe.ca/ 3) Lunch Program – Tuesday (Dominos), Thursday (Pita Pit, Subway, Boston Pizza and Guac Mexi Grill), First Friday of the Month (Menchies), other Fridays (Popcorn) 4) Ice Cream Sandwiches - April 13, May 11, June 15 5) Directed donation through WRDSB https://www.wrdsb.ca/wefi/donate/ a. Under "Donation Details" select Millen Woods PS -0519 under the "Fund" drop-down menu	

Mission Statement

"The Millen Woods School Council is a body of volunteers created to support and enhance learning for all students through the cooperative efforts of parents/guardians, students, staff members and others in the community."

What We Do

Here at Millen Woods, our School Council works with the school administration to organize fundraising efforts to support events and activities within the school. These events and activities help enrich what the amazing staff already does for our children.

Some of the enrichment items include:

- Additional classroom resources for children, such as decodable texts
- Guest Speakers in the School
- Funding busing costs for classroom field trips and the Area Track & Field Meet
- Nutrition Break Enrichment (playground equipment, maintenance and sports equipment)
- Community Outreach Efforts (Winter Wonderland and Year-End Social)
- Technology Replacements in the Classroom not funded by the WRDSB (Projectors, Document Cameras)
- Additional Kindergarten equipment and resources

This year, we anticipate the installation of a Gaga Ball Pit, along with some new Kindergarten bicycles for the playground!

As Council, we also organize Free Family Events at the school, such as Winter Wonderland and the Year-End Social.

We also provide support, guidance and input for the administration on what we would like to see as a parent/caregiver body.

Council meets once a month (on the 2nd Wednesday of the month) for approximately 1.5 hours, in person at the school library or via Google Meet.

List of 2025-26 Council Meeting dates:

- September 17, 2025 @ 6:30 PM (3rd Wednesday due to Meet the Community event)
- October 8, 2025 @ 6:30 PM
- November 12, 2025 @ 6:30 PM
- December 10, 2025 @ 6:30 PM
- January 14, 2026 @ 6:30 PM
- February 11, 2026 @ 6:30 PM
- April 8, 2026 @ 6:30 PM
- May 13, 2026 @ 6:30 PM
- June 10, 2026 @ 6:30 PM